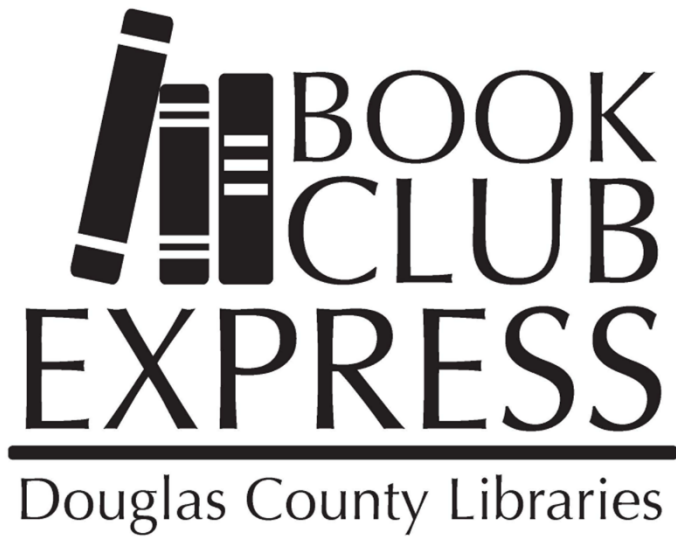




Watch Me by Tahereh Mari

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Discussion Questions

General Impressions

Gather initial thoughts and broad opinions about the book.

1. Describe your experience of reading the story from two different perspectives. How did it affect your reading experience and your understanding of the characters?
2. Did any aspects of the novel story seem forced, inconsistent, or unexplained? Discuss how this affected your reading of the novel.
3. Did you empathize more with Rosa or James? Why?

Personal Reflection and Connection

Encourage readers to connect the book's themes and characters with their personal experiences.

1. Rosa lives under someone else's control and never has a chance to figure out who she is. Describe a time in your life when you felt pressured to be something you were not, and how you handled the situation.
2. What might it be like to live in Rosa's world, where every thought and action is heavily surveilled? Have you ever been in a situation in which you felt your privacy was impinged upon? How did it affect your behavior?
3. Have you ever felt like James, torn between your duty and your feelings for another person? What did you learn from that experience?
4. Rosa feels the need to shut down her emotions, both literally and figuratively, in order to avoid pain. What are your experiences with pain avoidance? Do you believe it's better to confront or avoid pain?

Societal and Cultural Context

Examine the book's relevance to societal issues, historical events, or cultural themes.

1. How does the story comment on the impending development of AI and its influence on society? What are the dangers it alludes to?
2. What is the author trying to say about the subjectivity of morality? Consider the respective "rules" of the Reestablishment and the New Republic. How do you see their approaches reflected in different cultures in the real world?

3. Consider the novel's treatment of family legacy, duty, and obligation. How do Rosa's and James's family legacies affect their present existence? How do you see this phenomenon manifest in our modern world?

Literary Analysis

Dive into the book's structure, characters, themes, and symbolism.

1. How does Rosa's "death" at the end of the novel affect your understanding of the themes of the narrative? How might this death really signal the start of a new life?
2. Discuss the symbolism of the apple that Rosa eats the first time she and James dine together. Why might the author have chosen this particular food? Consider its possible symbolic meanings.
3. Compare the two worlds represented in the narrative: Ark Island and the New Republic. How do they differ, and how are they alike? How do these settings work to amplify the themes of the novel?
4. Discuss Mafi's representation of class in the novel. How does the story explore the contrast between the lives of the wealthy and the impoverished?

Creative Engagement

Encourage imaginative and creative connections to the book.

1. Imagine a film adaptation of Watch Me. Who would you choose to cast as the lead roles if this novel were adapted into a film or television series and why? Are there aspects of the plot that you would particularly focus on or decide to omit? Why?
2. Sketch out an outline for the sequel to Watch Me, justifying your predictions with evidence from the novel.
3. Draw a map of Ark Island, based on the descriptions in the book. If you were to visit Ark Island, where would you go? What would you do? Is there anyone you would want to meet or avoid?

Author Biography

Tahereh Mafi is the #1 New York Times bestselling, #1 international bestselling, and National Book Award-nominated author of over a dozen novels.

Best known for the Shatter Me series, her books have sold millions of copies, and have been translated into over thirty languages. Her first contemporary novel, *A Very Large Expanse of Sea*, was named by Time magazine as one of “the best YA books of all time”, and is in development for film with Levantine Films. She currently resides in Southern California with her husband, fellow author Ransom Riggs, and their daughter. Her most recent novel, the second book in a new fantasy series, *These Infinite Threads*, is on shelves now.

Her work is represented by Jodi Reamer of Writers House, LLC.

<https://www.taherehmafi.com/about>

Reviews

"This new entry journeys back to the Shatter Me universe, maintaining the series legacy of deadly protagonists, surveillance states, and propulsive romance. Will thrill fans of the originals and bring new readership to the older titles." - Booklist Online

"The balance between the suspense and dramatic action sequences feels cinematic, and the slow-burn romance shimmers beneath the darker, trauma-tinged themes of mental health, sinister applications of biotechnology, and food insecurity. Gripping." - Kirkus Reviews

Read-Alikes

Skyhunter by Marie Lu

Talin is a Striker, a member of an elite fighting force that stands as the last defense for the only free nation in the world: Mara. A refugee, Talin knows firsthand the horrors of the Federation, a world-dominating war machine responsible for destroying nation after nation with its terrifying army of mutant beasts known only as Ghosts. But when a mysterious prisoner is brought from the front to Mara's capital, Talin senses there's more to him than meets the eye. Is he a spy from the Federation? What secrets is he hiding? Only one thing is clear: Talin is ready to fight to the death alongside her fellow Strikers for the only homeland she has left . . . with or without the boy who might just be the weapon to save—or destroy—they all. Loyalty is life.

Red Queen by Aveyard

Mare Barrow's world is divided by blood--those with common, Red blood serve the Silver-blooded elite, who are gifted with superhuman abilities. Mare is a Red, scraping by as a thief in a poor, rural village, until a twist of fate throws her in front of the Silver court. Before the king, princes, and all the nobles, she discovers she has an ability of her own. To cover up this impossibility, the king forces her to play the role of a lost Silver princess and betroths her to one of his own sons. As Mare is drawn further into the Silver world, she risks everything and uses her new position to help the Scarlet Guard--a growing Red rebellion--even as her heart tugs her in an impossible direction. One wrong move can lead to her death, but in the dangerous game she plays, the only certainty is betrayal.

This Woven Kingdom by Tahereh Mafi

To all the world, Alizeh is a disposable servant, not the long-lost heir to an ancient Jinn kingdom forced to hide in plain sight. The crown prince, Kamran, has heard the prophecies foretelling the death of his king. But he could never have imagined that the servant girl with the strange eyes, the girl he can't put out of his mind, would one day soon uproot his kingdom--and the world

Scythe by Neal Shusterman

A world with no hunger, no disease, no war, no misery: humanity has conquered them all...even death. Now Scythes are the only ones who can end life, and they are commanded to do so in order to keep the size of the population under control. Citra and Rowan are chosen to apprentice to a scythe—a role that neither wants. These teens must master the “art” of taking life, knowing that failure could mean losing their own. The more they train, the more Citra and Rowan learn that a perfect world comes with a heavy price.

Throne of Glass by Sarah J. Maas

In a land without magic, an assassin is summoned to the castle. She has no love for the vicious king who rules from his throne of glass, but she has not come to kill him. She has come to win her freedom. If she defeats twenty-three murderers, thieves, and warriors in a competition, she will be released from prison to serve as the King's Champion. Her name is Celaena Sardothien. The Crown Prince will provoke her. The Captain of the Guard will protect her. And a princess from a faraway country will befriend her. But something rotten dwells in the castle, and it's there to kill. When her competitors start dying mysteriously, one by one, Celaena's fight for freedom becomes a fight for survival—and a desperate quest to root out the evil before it destroys her world.

The Cruel Prince by Holly Black

Of course I want to be like them. They're beautiful as blades forged in some divine fire. They will live forever. And Cardan is even more beautiful than the rest. I hate him more than all the others. I hate him so much that sometimes when I look at him, I can hardly breathe. Jude was seven years old when her parents were murdered and she and her two sisters were stolen away to live in the treacherous High Court of Faerie. Ten years later, Jude wants nothing more than to belong there, despite her mortality. But many of the fey despise humans. Especially Prince Cardan, the youngest and wickedest son of the High King.

Caraval by Stephanie Garber

Scarlett has never left the tiny island where she and her beloved sister, Tella, live with their powerful and cruel father. Now Scarlett's father has arranged a marriage for her, and Scarlett thinks her dreams of seeing Caraval, the far-away, once-a-year performance where the audience participates in the show, are over. But this year, Scarlett's long-dreamt-of invitation finally arrives. With the help of a mysterious sailor, Tella whisks Scarlett away to attend. Only, as soon as they arrive, Tella is kidnapped by Caraval's mastermind organizer, Legend. It turns out that this season's Caraval revolves around Tella, and whoever finds her first is the winner. Scarlett has been told that everything that happens during Caraval is only an elaborate performance. But whether Caraval is real or not, she must find Tella before the five nights of the game are over, and her sister disappears forever.